



YOU ARE PLAYING

Avery Vale

Apprentice Clockmaker

“Seven years at the workbench, and I can still hear every tick in that tower.”



FOR AVERY VALE'S EYES ONLY

Do not share this booklet. Do not read ahead of the rounds.

COSTUME IDEA

A waistcoat or work apron, rolled-up sleeves, and a jeweller's loupe or magnifier on a cord. Bonus: a pencil tucked behind one ear.

WHAT EVERYONE KNOWS ABOUT YOU

Ellis Pendleworth's apprentice for seven years. Avery knows every gear inside Old Lark, and was the one who found Ellis in the workshop at 10:28.

- ◆ **Ellis Pendleworth:** your teacher, and the closest thing you have to family
- ◆ **Harper Lune:** arrived in town today, introducing themselves as Ellis's relative
- ◆ **Reese Calloway:** the City watchmaker Ellis never quite trusted

PAGE 2

Before the game

Read before guests arrive

PAGE 3

Rounds 1 · 2

Read each only when told

PAGE 4

Round 3 · Notes

Suspects & your theories

Turn the page only when you are ready to begin. Detective Rowan Hale will tell you when to read each round.



Before the game



THE TRUTH

You are innocent. You did not harm Ellis. But you do have something to hide, so tonight you will look suspicious.

Your background

You walked into Pendleworth & Co. Clockworks at sixteen and never left. Ellis taught you everything, from oiling a pocket watch to keeping Old Lark on time. The whole town expects you to receive the keys to Old Lark tonight.

YOUR SECRET

Yesterday you peeked into Ellis's pocket diary. It said the keys to Old Lark would go to Harper Lune, a relative you had never heard of. You felt crushed and a little angry, and you have told no one. You would never have harmed Ellis.

Your story tonight

At 9:54 you walked down the corridor (Emerson Quill was already on the bench there), chatted with Ellis in the workshop, then climbed the tower stairs at 9:56 to oil Old Lark before midnight. The tower time clock stamped you in and out. At 10:27 you came back down into the workshop, and at 10:28 you found Ellis asleep at the workbench and could not wake them.

Your goals tonight

- ◆ Find out who harmed Ellis
- ◆ Keep your peek at the diary secret for as long as you can
- ◆ Prove you deserve to look after Old Lark

HOW THIS BOOKLET WORKS

- ◆ Page 3 holds Rounds 1 and 2; page 4 holds Round 3. Read each round **only when Detective Rowan Hale announces it**.
- ◆ Print this booklet **single-sided** so later rounds never show through. You can also cut along the dashed line on page 3 and hand out the rounds one at a time.
- ◆ Share what your round tells you to share. Everything on this page stays secret unless a round says otherwise.

Rounds 1 and 2



★ Round 1



Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 1.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ Ellis winds the workshop mantel clock at ten o'clock sharp every night. In seven years, Ellis never missed it once.
- ◆ At 9:54 you passed Emerson Quill on the corridor bench, already scribbling in a notebook.
- ◆ When you left Ellis at 9:56, Ellis was cheerful and humming, winding key ready in hand for ten o'clock.

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Reese Calloway** what business a City watchmaker has at a small-town gala.
- ◆ Ask **Devon Ashby** who was allowed into the workshop tonight.

YOUR TASK

Tell at least three people about Ellis's ten o'clock winding habit, and ask them what the stopped clock could mean.

----- ✂ FOLD OR CUT HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE -----

★ Round 2



Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 2.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ At 7:00, while setting up, Devon Ashby pointed at the little brown bottle on the workshop shelf and asked what it was. You said: "Ellis's sleeping drops. Three drops and Ellis sleeps like a stone."
- ◆ If anyone mentions the tower: the punch card (E7) shows exactly when you went up and came down.
- ◆ Whoever holds Old Lark's keys starts the town's midnight countdown. It is the biggest honour in Larkhaven.

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Harper Lune** when they really met Ellis for the first time.
- ◆ Ask **Emerson Quill** what they saw from the corridor bench after ten o'clock.

YOUR TASK

Find the tower punch card (E7) on the evidence table and show it to anyone who suspects you.

Round 3 and notes



Round 3

Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 3.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ If the pocket diary (E12) comes up, admit you read it yesterday. You were hurt, not hateful.
- ◆ When you came down at 10:27, the workshop was very quiet. Ellis’s blue mug stood on the bench, almost empty.
- ◆ Emerson Quill was still on the corridor bench, pencil in hand, when you ran out calling for help at 10:28.

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Devon Ashby** where the gold ribbon for the party favours came from.
- ◆ Ask **Parker Brightwell** what Ellis wanted to tell them after the announcement.

YOUR TASK

Make peace with Harper Lune in front of the group: tell Harper one thing Old Lark needs every New Year’s Eve.

Notes

Suspects at a glance

Avery Vale · Apprentice Clockmaker
Reese Calloway · Rival Watchmaker from the City
Harper Lune · The Clockmaker’s Long-Lost Relative
Kit Sterling · Antique Dealer
Rory Penhallow · Keeper of the Clock Tower
Dakota Fenwick · Fireworks Master

Parker Brightwell · Mayor of Larkhaven
Emerson Quill · Reporter, The Larkhaven Ledger
Devon Ashby · Gala Party Planner
Sage Whitfield · Gala Pianist & Bandleader
Blair Okafor · Town Historian
Marley Ashgrove · Society Photographer